



Individual Instructor Report Fall 2025 Version B for I 304 - PROGRAMMING FOR INFORMATICS (29555) (Huimin Xu)

Project Title: **Course Evaluations Fall 2025**

Courses Audience: **26**

Responses Received: **16**

Response Ratio: **61.5 %**

Subject Details

merged_subject_id

merged_subject_display_name

Report Comments

Guide to the Interpretation of Course Evaluations at UT Austin

The goal of course evaluation process at UT Austin is to drive teaching excellence and to support continuous improvement in teaching and learning experiences. Course evaluations provide snapshots of student perspectives on their course-level learning experiences. Most experts on teaching evaluation advise that no individual method gives the complete picture of an instructor's teaching effectiveness, multiple and diverse measures, on multiple occasions, are advised to give a full picture of the teaching effectiveness of a particular instructor. Moreover, other factors, such as size of class, level of the class, and content of the course, can cause small variations in the ratings. Therefore, student perspectives for a particular instructor or course should be interpreted as a snapshot, and not as providing complete information on the teaching effectiveness of that instructor. For additional details, including the scales and how the Mean scores are calculated, please review the Report Guide at the end of this document or, [UT Austin's Viewing Course Evaluation Results webpage](#).

Creation Date: **Monday, January 26, 2026**

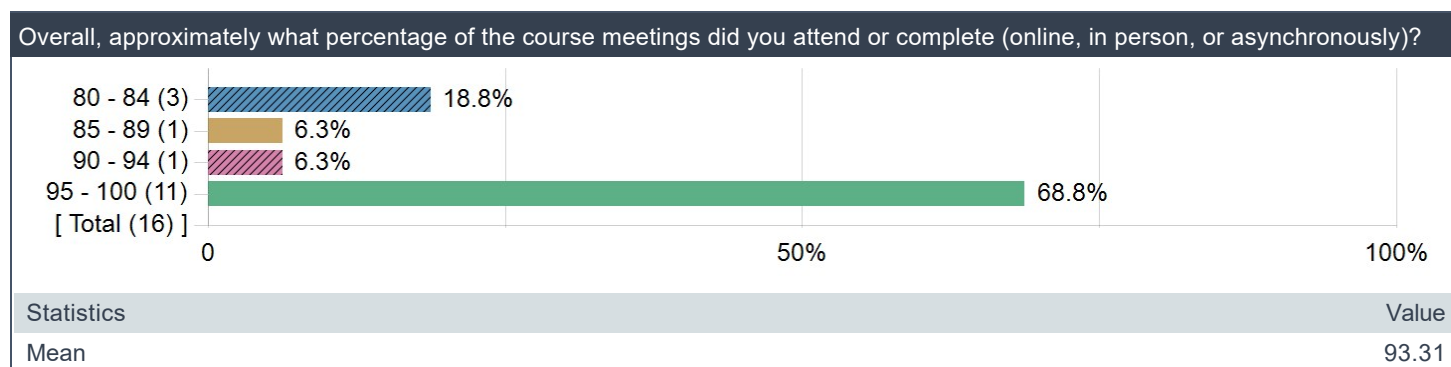
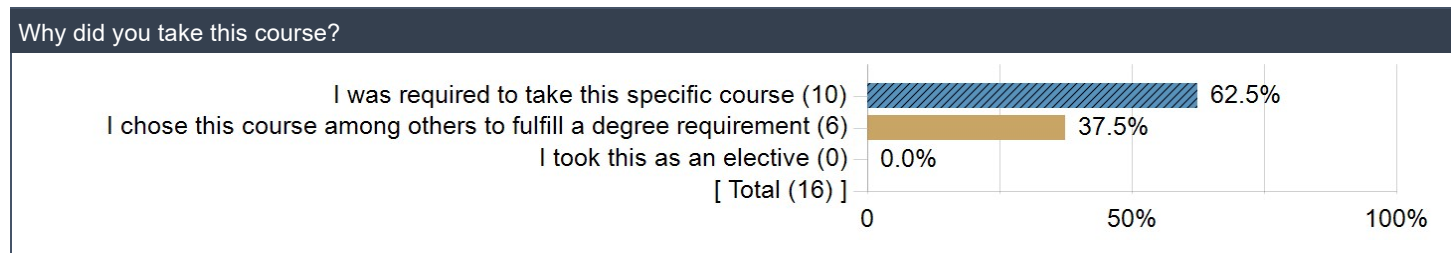
Core Questions

	Strongly Agree	Agree	Neutral	Disagree	Strongly Disagree	Responded	Mean
During this course, I gained a deeper understanding of the subject matter.	25.0%	25.0%	31.3%	18.8%	0.0%	16	3.56
The course was well organized.	18.8%	37.5%	31.3%	12.5%	0.0%	16	3.63
The instructor clearly explained the course objectives and expectations.	43.8%	31.3%	25.0%	0.0%	0.0%	16	4.19
The instructor fostered an inclusive learning environment.	43.8%	37.5%	18.8%	0.0%	0.0%	16	4.25
The instructor effectively explained the concepts and subject matter in this course.	25.0%	31.3%	18.8%	18.8%	6.3%	16	3.50
The instructional techniques kept me engaged in learning.	25.0%	25.0%	12.5%	31.3%	6.3%	16	3.31
The instructor checked for student understanding of the concepts presented in the course.	25.0%	50.0%	12.5%	12.5%	0.0%	16	3.88

Overall Questions

	Excellent	Very Good	Satisfactory	Unsatisfactory	Very Unsatisfactory	Responded	Mean
Overall, this instructor was	18.8%	37.5%	31.3%	12.5%	0.0%	16	3.63
Overall, this course was	31.3%	18.8%	31.3%	18.8%	0.0%	16	3.63

Other Course Questions



Comment Questions

Identify aspects of the course that were the most effective in helping your learning.

Comment
She was really easy to reach when I had questions about the course and was always willing to meet after class. I also liked that she individually would check on each of us and our work to make sure we were all okay. Very sweet and understanding!
The well-laid-out curriculum was easy to follow, and the guest lectures were very nice.
I liked when we had guest speakers who spoke on real-world stuff.
colab notebooks and the group project
She was readily available during office hours and by email if we had any questions about the content.
Aspects of the course that were the most effective were the specific discussions posted via Google Colab that students were able to access every week. This gave students a way to follow along on their computer instead of having to look at the projector screen.
Having the teacher interact with us when we needed help was beneficial.
Applying the
Being able to learn the fundamentals of Python Programming
I think having the open CoLabs was very helpful
The example code and labs we were given were very thorough in giving examples of what could be done with specific codes.
Very structured assignments and we knew what she expected.

Identify the aspect of the course that you found most challenging, why you found it was challenging, and suggest one thing that could be done to help future students meet that challenge more effectively.

Comment
I found it challenging that she taught from slides all the time. Since I was new to programming, it would have been helpful if she would have written code with us rather than having all the code done on Google Colab and then explaining it. I had a hard time picking up concepts because we didn't really have homework or ways to practice programming. We just dove straight into projects when we were all brand new to the subject and it was very anxiety inducing at times.
I didn't have much Python knowledge before this course
n/a
I don't feel as if the structure of the class was conducive to a deep understanding of the material. All that was required was final projects. We went to class, watched a demonstration, and completed projects. There needed to be more checkpoints during the semester to evaluate our understanding of the material, whether in the form of homework or something else.
Aspects of the course that I found most challenging are learning overall within the course. Due to a smaller class size, my classmates often relied on each other because they lacked a profound understanding of the course material. In the beginning, our instructor made it clear that there have been many professors who have taught this course, and there was no true syllabus or guide on how the course should have been taught. As a result, I felt as if many concepts/topics that are helpful in computer science were skipped heavily.
Having clearer instructions for projects would have been helpful.
It was hard to follow along with the in-class lectures; there weren't really any points where our understanding of the concepts was checked, and it was hard to feel like I got a decent understanding of the concepts when I was just listening to the lecture and not applying them myself to anything. I would suggest covering less in a day and maybe breaking down the code so we can understand structurally how it works better.
None of the aspects was challenging
Sometimes the assignment descriptions were a little too vague
We had very few assignments. It was quite difficult to learn python when there were few assignments and few opportunities in class to practice and actually apply and practice our programming skills. Most of the classes were only lectures, and it is very difficult to learn programming just through lecturing. In the future, more assignments (like small weekly quizzes or small weekly assignments) to test our knowledge and allow us to learn programming would be helpful for us to advance our knowledge.

Report Guide

Guide to the Interpretation of Course Evaluations at UT Austin

The goal of course evaluation process at UT Austin is to drive teaching excellence and to support continuous improvement in teaching and learning experiences. The two sets of scales used for core evaluation questions and the associated weights are:

Strongly Agree (5)
Agree (4)
Neutral (3)
Disagree (2)
Strongly Disagree (1)

Excellent (5)
Very Good (4)
Satisfactory (3)
Unsatisfactory (2)
Very Unsatisfactory (1)

The Mean is calculated by adding all of the weights for a single question and dividing by the number of respondents. The course workload question is not averaged.

The number of students (e.g. respondents) marking each option is reported for each of the items. These frequency distributions provide information about the level of student ratings and the spread and shape of the class distribution of responses. The distributions thus provide a picture of student perception of a course.

Course evaluations provide snapshots of student perspectives on their course-level learning experiences. Most experts on teaching evaluation advise that no individual method gives the complete picture of an instructor's teaching effectiveness; multiple and diverse measures, on multiple occasions, are advised to give a full picture of the teaching effectiveness of a particular instructor. Moreover, other factors, such as size of class, level of the class, and content of the course, can cause small variations in the ratings. Therefore, student perspectives for a particular instructor or course should be interpreted as a snapshot, and not as providing complete information on the teaching effectiveness of that instructor.